

A HEALTHCARE CONSULTING BRIEFING

What 1,000 Bootstrapped Startups Reveal About Building in Health & Wellness

A revenue-based market read for founders building health, fitness, and wellness products

What this data actually is

1,000 small, independently-run software businesses — mostly solo founders and tiny teams — each with real, self-reported monthly revenue. Think of it as a candid snapshot of the ground floor of the startup world, not venture-funded “big health-tech.”



1,000

companies tracked

Across AI, SaaS, fitness apps, marketplaces & more



89

are health-related

Fitness, wellness, mental health, clinics & care tools



\$13.5M

combined monthly revenue

Real, verified recurring revenue — not projections

Why it matters: this is the real, unfiltered base of the market — the businesses most founders in this room are actually building against.

A handful of winners carry the whole market

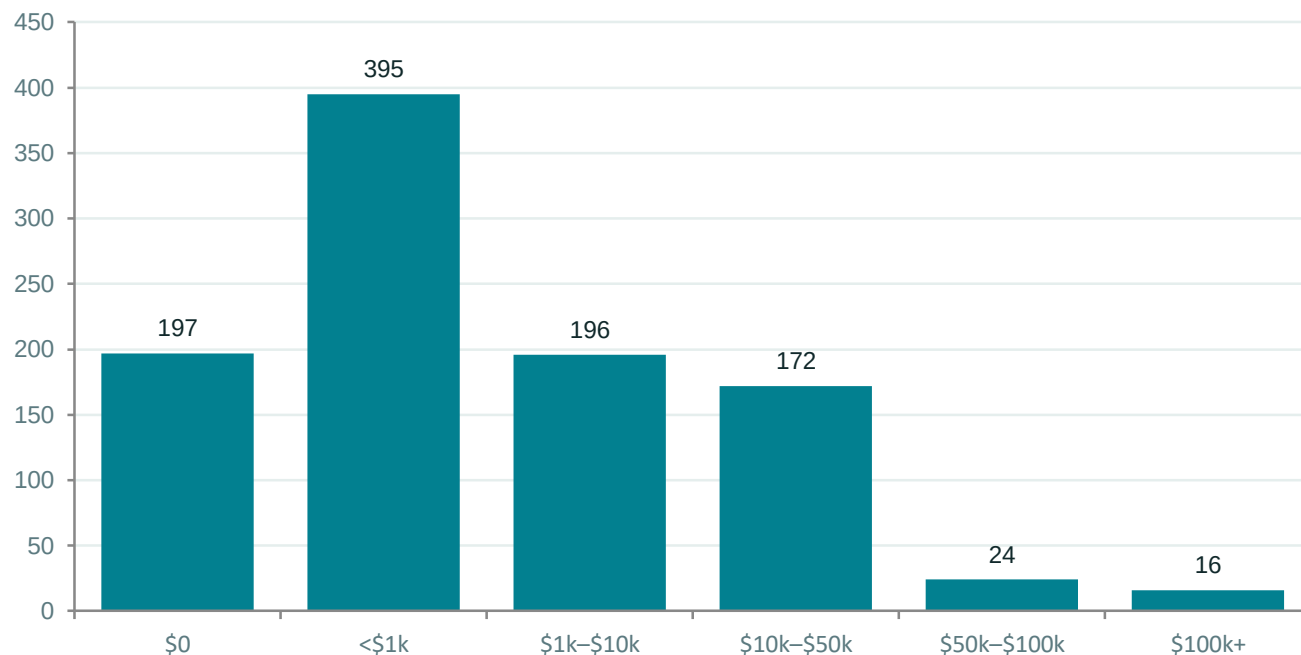
\$282

is the median company's monthly revenue — most businesses are tiny

58%

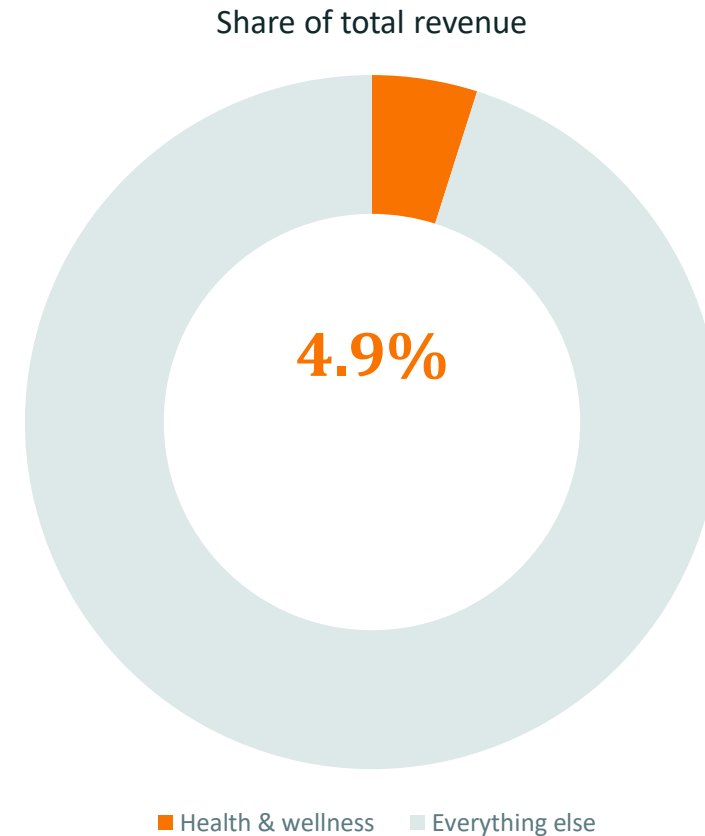
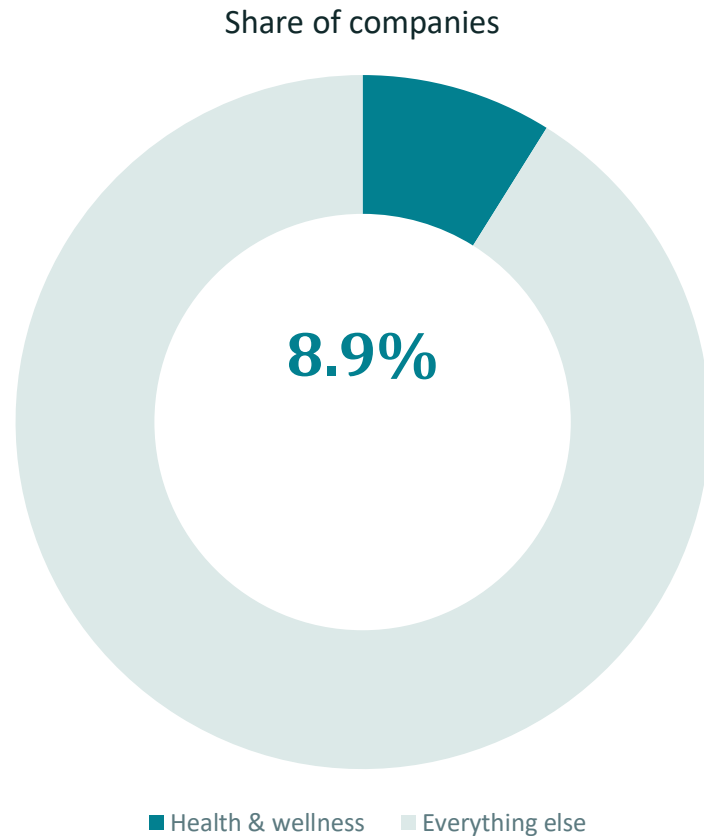
of all monthly revenue is earned by just the top 20 companies (2% of the sample)

Monthly revenue distribution — all 1,000 companies



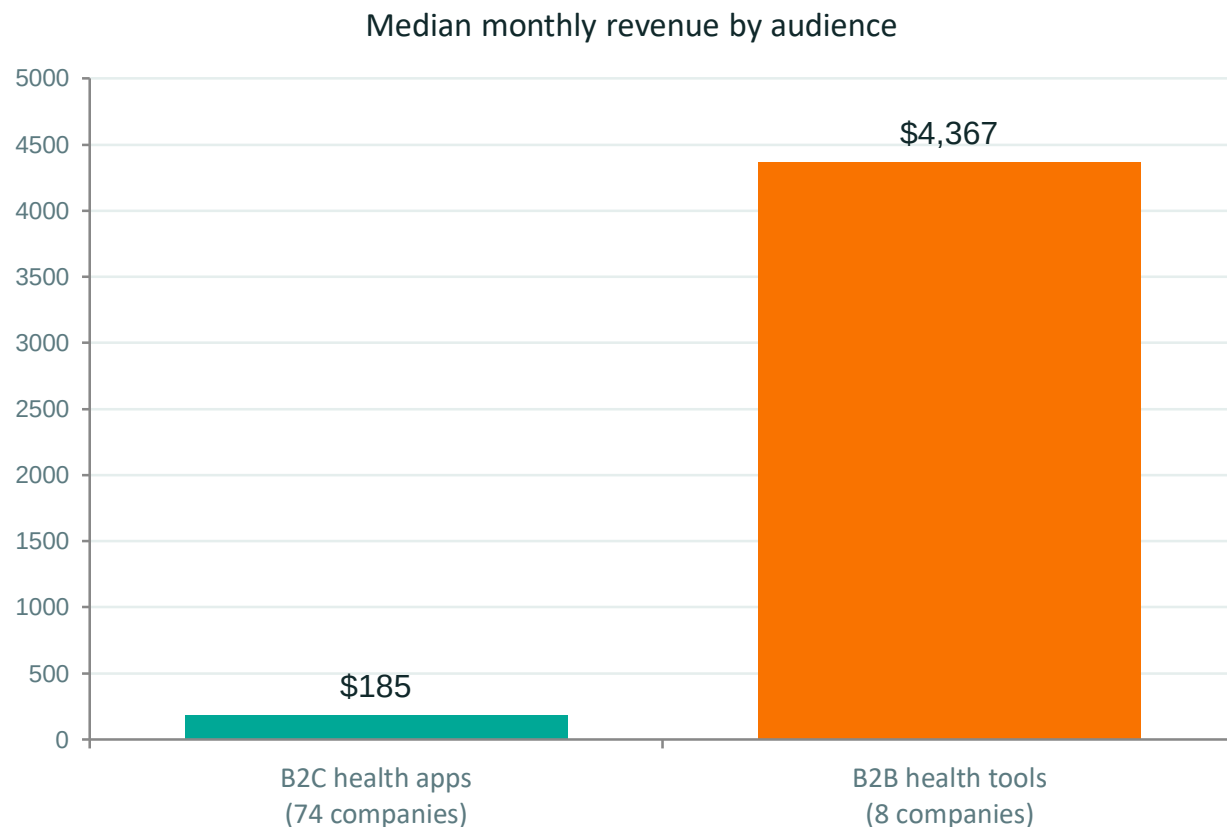
Read: building a health product is playing the same long-odds, power-law game as every other software startup.

Health & wellness: a small, still-forming slice



The takeaway: health makes up 9% of the companies but only 5% of the revenue — the category is real, but still under-monetized relative to its size.

Selling to the clinic beats selling to the patient



~24x

higher median revenue for tools sold to health & wellness professionals, practices, and providers — versus apps sold directly to consumers.

Why: practices and providers have budget, pay predictably, and stick around — while individual patients churn fast and resist subscriptions.

What the top health performers have in common



Build the back office, not another app

The biggest earner in the segment, Kibu, sells practice-management software to disability-care providers — not another consumer wellness app.

\$234K / month



Pick one narrow, specific problem

Winners target one condition or life stage — teen growth tracking, GLP-1 treatment journeys, IBS symptom logs — not “general wellness.”

GoTall, Shotwise, FlareCare

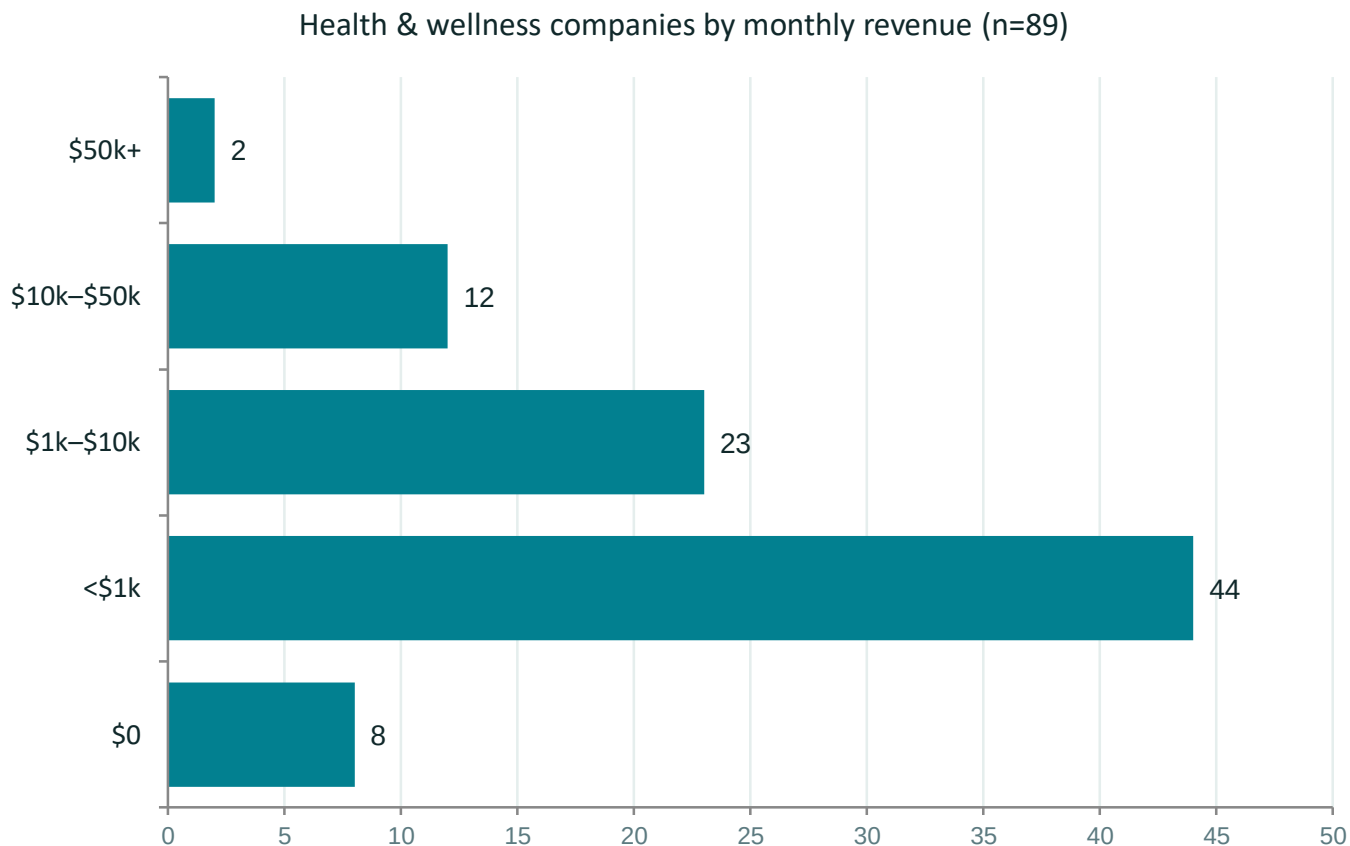


Sell to the practitioner, then the patient

Calendesk (scheduling for therapists & clinics) and EliteTrainer (tools for personal trainers) both grow steadily by serving professionals.

Steady, recurring growth

Most health startups are still finding traction



~1 in 2

health startups in this sample earn under \$1,000 a month — traction takes time, even in a category everyone agrees is important.

Plan for it: budget for a long, patient runway to first traction — trust and habit-formation in health take longer to earn than in most other categories.

LOOKING AHEAD

What buyers actually pay for a health startup

32 health & wellness companies in this dataset are listed for sale — giving a real read on how buyers price this category today.

MARKET-WIDE

2.3x

median revenue multiple across 262 companies for sale, all categories

HEALTH & WELLNESS

2.05x

median revenue multiple across 32 health companies for sale

Reads slightly lower: buyers appear to price in retention and compliance risk on consumer health apps — strong retention data is a real lever for a better exit price.

Five takeaways to build on



Sell to the practice or provider first — B2B health tools earn ~24x more per company than consumer apps in this data.



Go narrow. Own one condition, life stage, or persona before you chase “general wellness.”



Budget for a long runway — about half of health startups here are still under \$1,000/month.



Free trials and freemium open the door, but the winners move users to clear paid tiers quickly.



If an exit is the goal, invest in retention early — it's what separates a 1x deal from a 4x+ deal.

**The market rewards founders
who pick a narrow wedge
and sell to whoever holds the budget.**

Thank you